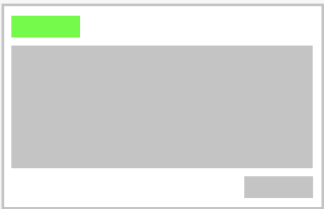


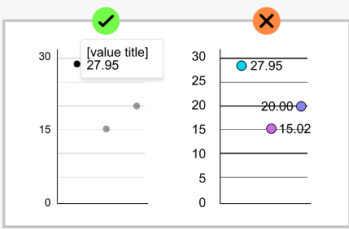
5-Point Design Checklist

1. Define Your Purpose



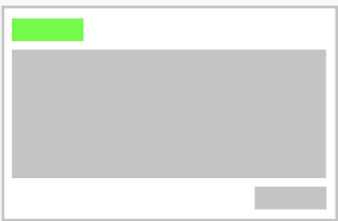
Ask all the questions you can. What is the main focus of this dashboard? How do we decide which metrics need to be front and center from those that can sit in the background to provide supporting information? Who is this dashboard for? As you answer your questions, the dashboard will take shape.

2. Remove to Improve



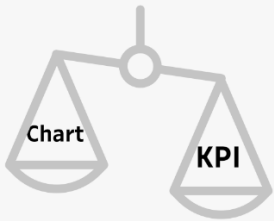
Although dashboard elements like titles, headers, text, colours, and lines can be informative, they can also be distracting. Be careful that yours add to the data, rather than distract from it. In general, reduce the prominence of chart elements like axis labels, and remove marks that don't add necessary understanding or context to your visual.

3. Check for Clear Hierarchy



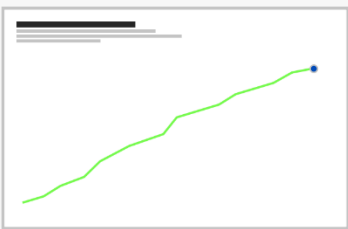
Make sure that the information presented has a clear hierarchy. The dashboard should read left to right, top to bottom, in order of importance. The higher and larger the data, the broader and more important the metric. The lower and smaller the data, the more granular it becomes. A good rule is to keep KPIs near the top and tables near the bottom.

4. Identify Visual Weight



It is impossible to control data. However, if we design with the intent to balance the dashboard with the right visual weight, we can unify our dashboards into a better visual experience. Does any part of your dashboard feel like it's about to be squished by a large bar chart? Ease those tensions with adequate whitespace and smart layout choices.

5. Add Context



Do you feel comfortable putting this dashboard in front of someone who's not familiar with it? Try it, and see if there are things that are not immediately clear to the user. Make use of legends to advise on colours and shapes, use subtitles to provide explanatory text and communicate interactively, and consider tooltips to add context, clarity, and provide further exploration.

Introduction

In this document, you will find the standards to create a **Deakin University** branded dashboard. By using these guidelines when creating new visualisations, the **Deakin** brand will be easily visible across all data platforms. We will go over the main elements in this style guide: Typography (how typefaces and text formatting affect the feel of space), Colour (how colour can be used as more than just aesthetics), and Usability (how the elements interact with each other to provide a seamless experience for the user).



Use the **Deakin** logo on all dashboards.

Typography

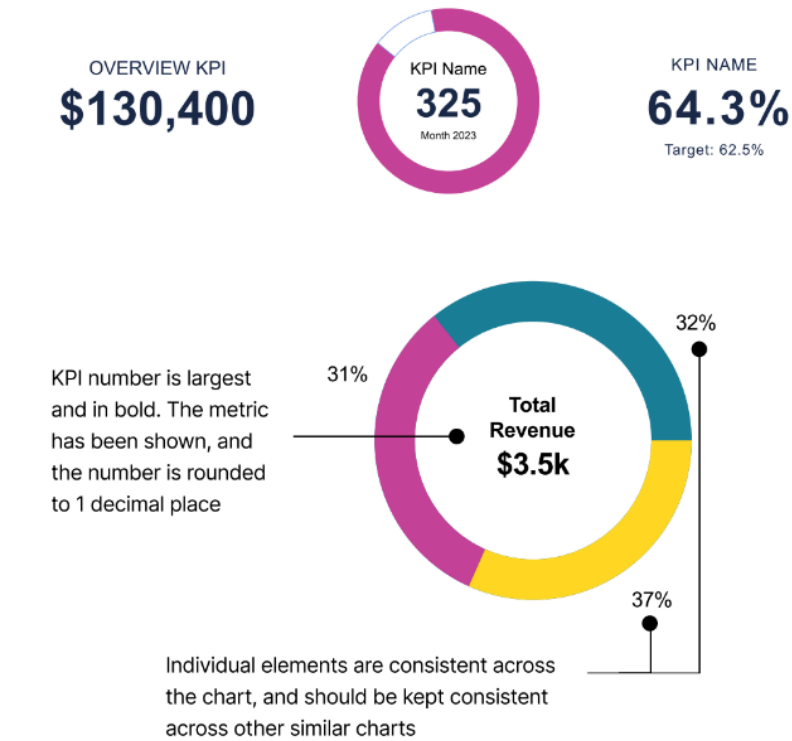
Tableau default is the recommended font. Keep the font consistent within your dashboard, and the sizes and styles consistent across similar elements. For example, the font size and style (bold / not bold etc) should be consistent for titles and KPIs.

KPIs

KPIs should be used sparingly, as they consume a lot of space, but they use this real estate to drive home the most important metrics in a particular dashboard. Keep these simple so the viewer isn't overloaded with visuals.

Number formatting

use the relevant metric units when displaying numeric values on your dashboard; for example **m for millions, k for thousands** etc. The difference between 300,000 and \$300K not only reduces the number of marks on your dashboard, it gives a clear understanding of the metric being discussed. Try rounding off values to the nearest decimal place or add decimal points when formatting axis, KPIs and tooltips.



Colour

PRIMARY COLOURS



INDICATOR COLOURS



TEXT COLOURS



GRADIENT COLOURS

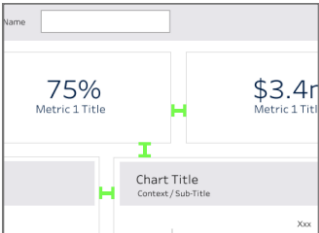


Usability

Aim for user-friendliness in your dashboard designs. Be descriptive in your dashboard titles to communicate what is being visualised.

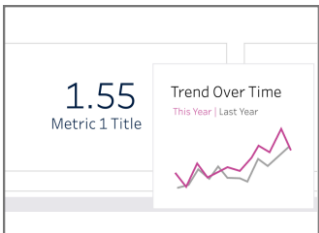
Element Spacing

Items on your dashboard should have 10px of space between them. If changes must be made to spacing, stay consistent everywhere and stick to a min of 8px and max 20px.



Dashboard Actions & Filters

Incorporate interactivity in your dashboard to provide greater flexibility, and avoid needing to show all items simultaneously. Filters that affect all items in a dashboard should sit in a specific filter pane e.g., along the left, or along the top of the dashboard. Filters that affect specific charts should sit with those charts e.g., in the header pane next to the chart title

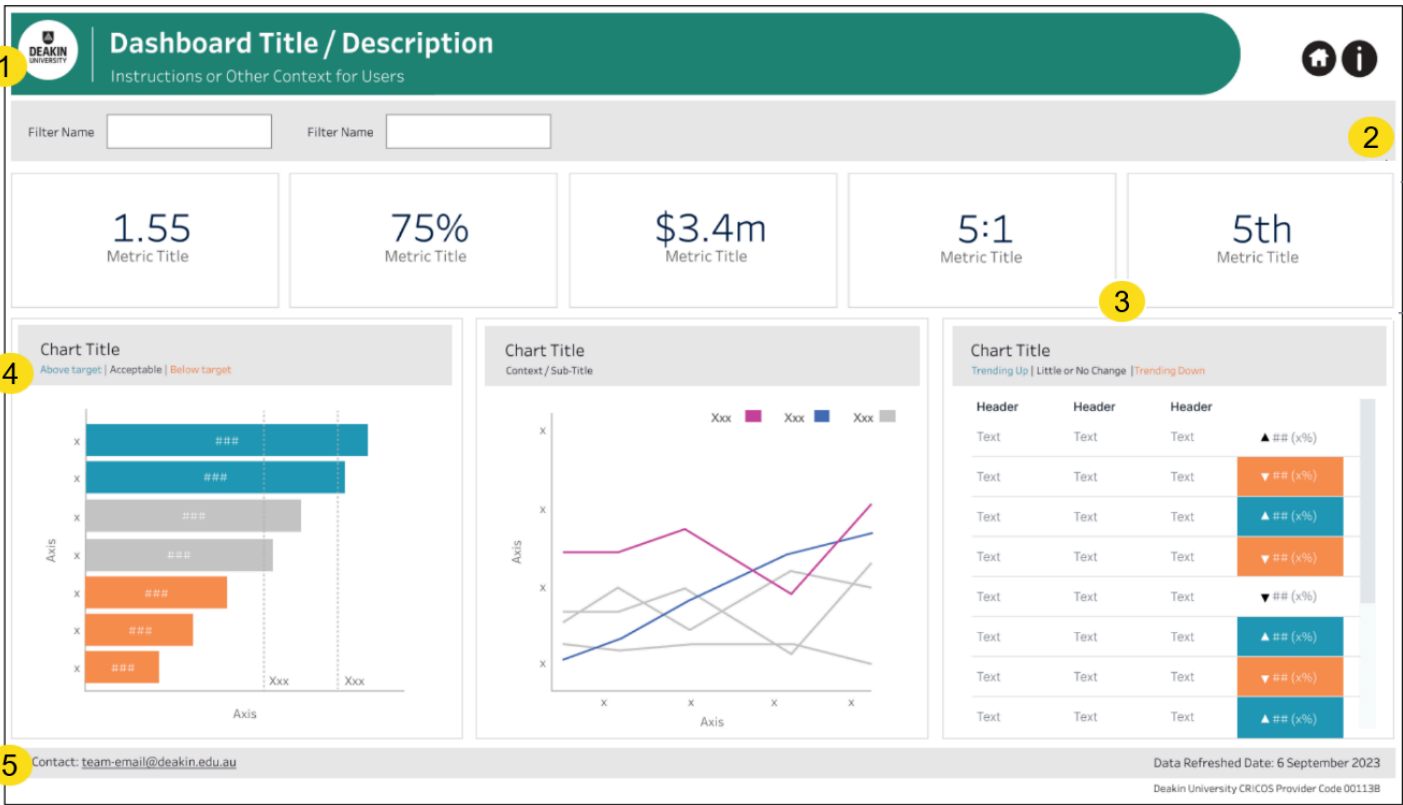


Tooltips

use tooltips to provide helpful secondary information. Information in tooltips shouldn't be essential to the view, but might provide additional context, clarity or invite further exploration. Keep tooltips simple and tidy. Click [here](#) for some ideas

Breakdown of Elements

On this page we will be breaking down the main elements that make up a Deakin dashboard. Deakin has two dashboard styles - one with the filters along the top, and one with the filters along the side; both are shown below. What you chose is up to your individual and team preferences.



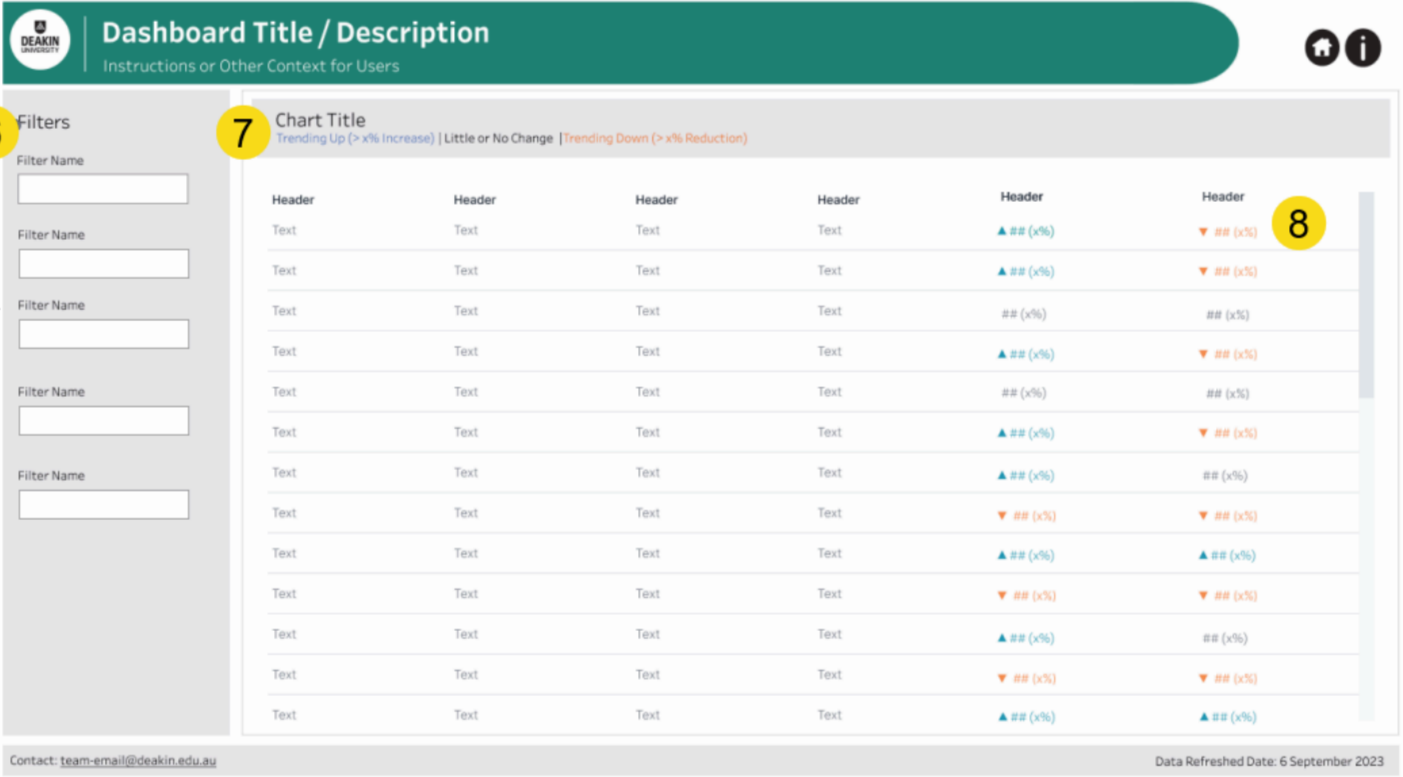
1. Banner
The banner should contain the Deakin logo and the dashboard title on the left, and the home and information icons on the right.

2. Top Filter Panel
This dashboard has filters along the top. This is a great choice for dashboards with a small number of filters.

3. Consistent Spacing
Each container should have equal distance between it and the next. This creates a uniform look that users will find easier to follow.

4. Legends
Ensure charts have clear legends. Legends can be shown in a variety of ways, including as a chart sub-header. You can find more information on legend options [here](#).

5. Footer
The footer should note the contact details for the team responsible for the dashboard. On the far right, the date the data snapshot. If you have multiple data sources, provide these details in the data definitions details included in the workbook.



6. Side Filter Panel
This dashboard has a filter panel along the left. This is a great choice for dashboards with 5 or more filters, or something more complex like radial buttons.

7. Grey Dividing Sections
Use light grey (#E7E6EA) for the footer, filter pane, container header panes and container borders.

8. Use of Colour
Colour is one of the first things users notice. Use it sparingly and with intent. Be mindful of the hierarchy of “Pre-Attentive Attributes” and leverage other tool to draw attention to particular items.

Alignment
Left align all headers, titles, and values. Keep alignment between like elements consistent e.g., align numbers within and between tables. Ensure axes in charts presented alongside one another line up.

Hierarchy and Layout
Use hierarchy and layout to tell your story. We generally read from left to right; let this help you organise the most important information on the dashboard. For easy consumption, lay out your dashboards in an F or Z formation, much like how you would read a book.

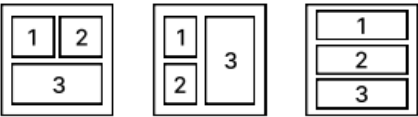


Chart Choice
Choose charts that fit your story and data. Keep them simple, limiting to common chart types unless you have a clear reason to vary. Great choices include KPIs, bars, lines, donuts, crosstabs, scatterplots and heatmaps.

Cross Tabs
Cross tabs should be used sparingly. When you use them:

- Keep them simple, with minimal colours, and simple headers. Use filters to reduce the amount shown at any one time.
- Ensure sufficient space for any text, and minimise the use of scroll bars wherever possible.
- Add colour and icons to convey key values, but keep it sparing to avoid overwhelming the user. Try and colour only key items, rather than every row.
- Icons can be added when formatting as a custom object, check out this link for more.

Font
Styles should be consistent throughout, e.g., headers should be the same size, weight and colour. Stick to the sizes below where possible. Use Tableau Book for all fonts and use proper case for all text.

Dashboard Size
Total dashboard size is recommended to be 1400 x 800. However depending on the content, this may be further customised.

Check when publishing
Items may move or look different when you publish. For example, Tableau renders text as different sizes compared to most other software, and floating objects may shift locations when viewed on screens of different sizes. Be sure to publish to a test environment, and have your dashboard peer reviewed before moving it to production.

Text	Bold	Size
Dashboard Title	✓	20pt
Dashboard Subtitle	✗	10pt
Container Title	✗	12pt
Container Subtitle	✗	8pt
KPI Values	✗	24pt
KPI Subtext	✗	9pt
Visualisation Values	✗	9pt
Chart Elements	✗	8pt